

2.6 Topic 4: Rebranding Places

Rebranding

The rural and urban environment includes a variety of places, some characterised by wealth, opportunity and excitement, others suffering from dereliction, deprivation and fighting to survive. Rebranding involves both re-imaging and regeneration, and includes a wide range of strategies by which places reinvent themselves to provide a more prosperous future. This topic explores why rebranding is necessary (eg spiral of decline, economic readjustment, and social problems) and explores how public/private funding can be used to implement flagship and community projects to improve holistically the environment, social fabric, lifestyle, and economy of places. Rebranding can be achieved by a number of strategies such as diversification of employment, landscape improvement, sports tourism, and the use of innovative and sustainable technology, often in combination.

Fieldwork and research opportunities

Fieldwork opportunities should allow students to study contrasting examples in both rural and urban areas. Investigating areas within the built environment which require re-imaging and redevelopment (eg use of quality surveys on housing, street furniture). Planning an urban tour – taking photographic evidence, using questionnaires – could be used to explore re-urbanisation and economic changes associated with such developments. Investigations might evaluate rural and heritage projects, **Research work** could include reviewing websites that promote re-imaging projects while census data (www.statistics.org.uk) is a rich seam of information from which to explore eg inward migration of particular socio-economic groups into areas (evidence of filtering and gentrification).

1 Time to rebrand

Enquiry question: *What is rebranding and why is it needed in some places?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ How places re-invent and market themselves by regeneration and re-imaging to attract work, residents and visitors.	■ Investigating the different types of rebranding and re-imaging and their purpose.
■ Ideas for rebranding towns and the countryside focusing on leisure and tourism, National Parks, culture, festivals etc to create a sense of identity and community.	■ Developing an awareness that different places use a variety of means to rebrand, for example Liverpool, Notting Hill, Wessex.
■ Why rebranding is needed in some places and the social, economic and environmental processes involved.	■ Examining why rebranding is needed because of, for example the spiral of decline, loss of industry and population change.
■ Fieldwork and research into the profile of places in need of rebranding, using surveys and secondary data.	■ Using primary and secondary sources to investigate these features such as environmental quality, photo panoramas, Goad maps, residential quality, neglect and dereliction, housing, employment, health and census data.

2 Rebranding strategies

Enquiry question: *Who are the 'rebranding players' and what strategies exist for places to improve themselves?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ The potential role of players in the rebranding process.	■ Investigating the role of various players such as public partners, private firms, headline sponsors, capitalists, agencies, not-for-profit organisations and government/EU departments.
■ Fieldwork and research into a range of rural strategies such as: ◆ rebranding local activities and farming. Integrated projects in the post-production countryside including rural heritage and specialist 'food-towns' ◆ using innovative arts and media projects and new technologies including community radio, films and the internet.	■ Using primary and secondary information to investigate a range of strategies that have been applied to rural areas such as: ◆ rural heritage and food towns, eg Ludlow ◆ rural theatre, community radio, the internet.
■ Fieldwork and research into urban strategies that include the following approaches: ◆ changing the built environment by rebranding of shopping, commercial and residential areas ◆ promoting city identity ◆ using sport as a catalyst for change and pump-priming engine ◆ rebranding a declining coastal holiday resort.	■ Using primary and secondary information to investigate a range of strategies that have been applied to urban areas such as: ◆ city centre flagship schemes and new waterfront locations aimed at tourism such as Birmingham, Newcastle ◆ regional and cultural centres such as Bradford ◆ enabling regeneration and economic recovery such as the Manchester Commonwealth Games or the 2012 London Olympics ◆ redevelopment in coastal resorts such as Newquay and Blackpool.

- Rebranding for a sustainable future.

- Researching examples of the use of legacy facilities, new infrastructure, conservation measures and involving people such as in Barcelona.

3 Managing rural rebranding

Enquiry question: *How successful has rebranding been in the countryside?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ Fieldwork and research into the success of specific examples of ways to implement rural rebranding using contrasting solutions such as: ◆ rural tourism – promoted via the media ◆ rural technology ◆ adding value locally ◆ rural diversification in the post-productive countryside	■ Using primary sources such as oral histories/interviews, maps, visitor surveys, sphere of influence, activity maps, and questionnaires alongside secondary sources, to investigate the success of named rural schemes such as: ◆ ‘Last of the Summer Wine’ country ◆ broadband provision in the Highlands and Islands of Scotland ◆ ‘leap-frogging’ landlines to mobile phones in India ◆ farm diversification schemes; organic food products ◆ rural enterprise schemes such as the Eden Project.

4 Managing urban rebranding

Enquiry question: *How successful have urban areas been in rebranding themselves?*

What students need to learn	Suggested teaching and learning
■ Fieldwork and research, into the success of specific examples of ways to implement urban Rebranding using contrasting solutions such as: ◆ flagship schemes in city centres, waterfronts, shorelines gentrification of suburbs ◆ heritage and tourism in historic centres ◆ sport and leisure provision.	■ Using primary (eg digital photographs to record the use of innovate design and new materials, use of spaces etc) maps of particular facilities and land-uses and secondary sources to investigate the success of named urban schemes such as: ◆ Birmingham city centre, Newcastle waterfront ◆ gentrification in Islington, Camden ◆ history and culture in York or Rome ◆ the Olympics, Manchester Commonwealth Games, Sheffield Student Games venues ◆ rebranding of a coastal resort, eg Blackpool.